Tally Server Security & Firewall Configuration

Hardening Guide for Windows Server 2019 & Quick Heal Server Edition

CRITICAL SECURITY NOTICE: *Turning off the firewall to allow network access exposes your server to automated ransomware bots, port scanning, and unauthorized data exfiltration. Never turn off the firewall. Follow the rule exceptions in this guide instead.*

1. Solving the Firewall Issue: Keep Firewall ON & Allow Tally

Tally requires specific inbound ports and executables to communicate across the local area network (LAN).

A. Required Ports & Executables Summary:

Component	Port / Protocol	Purpose
Tally License / Gateway Server	**TCP 9000** (or 9999)	License sharing & Gateway service
TallyPrime Server (Enterprise)	**TCP 9080**	Dedicated multi-user data server engine
Windows File Sharing (SMB)	**TCP 445, 139** **UDP 137, 138**	Access to shared Tally Data folder across LAN
Tally Executables	Any / Direct EXE	tally.exe, tallygatewayserver.exe

B. Windows Firewall Instant Setup (PowerShell):

Run the following commands in **PowerShell as Administrator** on the Server:

```
# 1. Allow Tally Gateway / License Ports
New-NetFirewallRule -DisplayName "Tally License Server (9000)" -Direction Inbound -LocalPort 9000 -Pr
otocol TCP -Action Allow -Profile Any
New-NetFirewallRule -DisplayName "TallyPrime Server (9080)" -Direction Inbound -LocalPort 9080 -Proto
col TCP -Action Allow -Profile Any

# 2. Allow Network File & Printer Sharing (for Tally Data folder)
Enable-NetFirewallRule -DisplayGroup "File and Printer Sharing"

# 3. Allow Tally Executables (update path if customized)
New-NetFirewallRule -DisplayName "TallyPrime Executable" -Direction Inbound -Program "C:\Program File
s\TallyPrime\tally.exe" -Action Allow -Profile Any
New-NetFirewallRule -DisplayName "Tally Gateway Server" -Direction Inbound -Program "C:\Program Files
\TallyPrime\tallygatewayserver.exe" -Action Allow -Profile Any
```

C. Quick Heal Server Edition Firewall Configuration:

- **Step 1:** Open Quick Heal Server Edition → **Protection** → **Firewall Protection**.
- **Step 2:** Under Network Profile, ensure your network adapter is set to **Home / Work (Trusted)**, NOT Public.
- **Step 3:** Go to **Firewall Rules / Advanced Rules** → Click **Add Rule** → Direction: **Inbound**, Protocol: **TCP**, Ports: 9000, 9080, 445 → Action: **Allow**.
- **Step 4:** Under **Program Rules**, add tally.exe and tallygatewayserver.exe and set access to **Allow**.

2. Tally Data Folder & Permission Hardening

Prevent unauthorized deletion, ransomware execution, and raw copying of your accounting records.

- **Hide Network Share:** Share the Tally Data directory with a $ at the end (e.g. \\SERVER\TallyData$). This prevents the shared folder from appearing when users or malware browse network devices.
- **Share Permissions vs NTFS Permissions:**
  - **Share Permissions:** Grant *Change* and *Read* only to Authenticated Tally Users. Remove Everyone.
  - **NTFS Permissions:** Grant *Read, Write, Modify* to Tally Users. Never grant 'Full Control' to regular users (prevents users/malware from changing file ownership or access control).
- **Separate User Accounts:** Never let users or technicians log in as the default Administrator. Create unique standard user accounts for each staff member.

3. Remote Access & Anti-Hacking Protection

Over 90% of server hacks happen due to exposed Remote Desktop (RDP) ports.

- **Never Expose Port 3389 to Public Internet:** Remove any router port-forwarding for port 3389. Connect remote branches/staff exclusively through a **VPN** (e.g. WireGuard, Tailscale, OpenVPN, or Router IPsec VPN).
- **IP Whitelisting on Firewall:** If RDP is necessary, restrict Inbound RDP rules to specific, static public IP addresses of your branches.
- **Account Lockout Policy:** Open secpol.msc → *Account Policies* → *Account Lockout Policy* → Set **Account lockout threshold** to **5 invalid attempts** (stops automated brute-force attacks).
- **Enforce MFA / 2FA:** Implement Multi-Factor Authentication (e.g., Duo Security for Windows RDP/Logon) for all remote sessions.

4. Tally Application-Level Security

- **Tally Security Control:** Enable Security Control in Tally (Company → Security). Assign role-based access (Data Entry, Auditor, Owner) with strong individual passwords.
- **TallyVault:** Use TallyVault to encrypt company data files so that even if raw files (.tsf) are stolen, they cannot be opened without the master decryption key.
- **TallyPrime Edit Log:** Use TallyPrime Edit Log to track every voucher creation, modification, or deletion with user identity and exact timestamps.

5. 3-2-1 Automated & Air-Gapped Backup Strategy

To ensure zero data loss from ransomware, disk failure, or hacking:

Tier	Type	Implementation Method
3 Copies	Live + 2 Backups	1 Live on Server + 1 Local Archive + 1 Cloud/Offsite Archive
2 Media	Different Formats	Fast NVMe/SSD Server storage + Dedicated NAS / External Drive
1 Air-Gapped	Immutable Cloud	Automated daily encrypted zip upload to Cloud (AWS S3 Object Lock, Google Drive, or Azure) with version retention.

6. Forensic Investigation Checklist (Checking Past Hack Attempts)

To investigate the suspicious activity on your server, perform these checks immediately:

Log / Tool	Event / Identifier	What to Look For
Event Viewer (Security.evtx)	**Event ID 4625**	Repeated failed logon attempts (indicates brute-force attacks via RDP or network share).
Event Viewer (Security.evtx)	**Event ID 4624** (Logon Type 10)	Successful Remote Desktop logons. Inspect the *Source Network Address* to check unknown IP addresses.
Event Viewer (Security.evtx)	**Event ID 4720 / 4728**	New local user created or added to the Administrators group by an attacker.
Quick Heal Logs	Ransomware / Firewall Reports	Blocked port scans, outbound command & control connections, or blocked payload scripts.
PowerShell	netstat -ano	Active external listening connections or unexpected remote IP sessions.

7. Client Connection Verification Steps

After configuring the firewall rules on the server, verify network connectivity from any client PC:

- **Test 1 - Network Ping:**
  ping <Server-IP-Address> (Checks basic ICMP connectivity)
- **Test 2 - Tally Port Test (PowerShell on Client PC):**
  Test-NetConnection -ComputerName <Server-IP-Address> -Port 9000
  Expected Result: TcpTestSucceeded : True
- **Test 3 - Shared Folder Access:**
  Press Win + R → Type \\<Server-IP-Address>\TallyData$ → Ensure client can open without errors.

Summary: Following this configuration ensures maximum security against ransomware and unauthorized access while keeping Tally high-performing and accessible across your local network.